

Contents

Preface	11
1 Drone Hardware and Assembly	17
1.1 Module Summary	19
1.2 Introduction: Quadcopter Flight Principles	20
1.2.1 The Four Fundamental Forces	20
1.2.2 Coordinate System and Movement	21
1.3 Rotor Aerodynamics	22
1.3.1 Elementary Momentum Theory	22
1.3.2 Thrust Coefficient	22
1.3.3 Propeller-Motor Relationship: KV	23
1.3.4 Efficiency and Figure of Merit	24
1.4 250mm Quadcopter X4 Specification	25
1.4.1 General Parameters	25
1.4.2 Thrust-to-Weight Ratio (T/W)	26
1.5 Component Selection	28
1.5.1 Brushless Motor (BLDC)	28
1.5.2 Propellers	29
1.5.3 Electronic Speed Controller (ESC)	31
1.5.4 Flight Controller: Ardupilot Options	33
1.5.5 LiPo Battery	35
1.6 Frame and Mechanical Structure	38
1.6.1 Frame Options 250mm	38
1.6.2 Weight Distribution	38
1.7 Complementary Systems	40
1.7.1 Radio Receiver (RX)	40
1.7.2 Telemetry (Communication Module)	40

- 1.7.3 GPS (Optional for this module) 40
 - 1.7.4 Vibration Dampers 41
- 1.8 Practical Performance Calculations 42
 - 1.8.1 Required Thrust Calculation 42
 - 1.8.2 Electrical Consumption Calculation 43
- 1.9 Step-by-Step Assembly 45
 - 1.9.1 Required Tools 45
 - 1.9.2 Step 1: Frame Preparation 46
 - 1.9.3 Step 2: Motor Installation 46
 - 1.9.4 Step 3: ESC Installation 47
 - 1.9.5 Step 4: Flight Controller Installation 47
 - 1.9.6 Step 5: Radio Receiver and Battery Installation 49
 - 1.9.7 Step 6: Final Pre-Flight Check 49
- 1.10 Propeller Balancing 50
 - 1.10.1 Static Balancing Procedure 50
- 1.11 Pre-Flight Calibration 51
 - 1.11.1 IMU Calibration (Accelerometer/Gyroscope) 51
 - 1.11.2 Compass Calibration (Magnetometer) 51
 - 1.11.3 Motor Configuration in QGroundControl 52
- 1.12 Ground Testing (Bench Testing) 53
 - 1.12.1 Motor Response Test 53
 - 1.12.2 Communication Test (Telemetry) 53
- 1.13 Troubleshooting: Common Problems 54
 - 1.13.1 The Drone Does Not Power On 54
 - 1.13.2 A Motor Does Not Spin 54
 - 1.13.3 Excessive Vibrations 54
- 1.14 Scaled Practical Projects 55
 - 1.14.1 Project 1.1: Component Selection (Basic) 55
 - 1.14.2 Project 1.2: Complete Assembly (Intermediate) 55
 - 1.14.3 Project 1.3: Performance Analysis (Advanced) 56
- 1.15 Additional Resources and References 57
 - 1.15.1 Online Calculators 57
 - 1.15.2 Technical Documentation 57
 - 1.15.3 Trusted Manufacturers 57
- 1.16 Final Checklist: Before Your First Flight 58
- 1.17 Critical Safety Notes 59
- 1.18 Assessment 60
 - 1.18.1 Knowledge Quiz 60

1.18.2	Practical Exercise	62
1.18.3	Integrative Project	63
1.18.4	Assessment Solutions	64
1.19	Next Step: Module 02 - Ardupilot	67
1.20	Glossary of Terms	68
2	Ardupilot and Autonomous Drone Control	71
2.1	Module Summary	73
2.2	Introduction to Ardupilot	74
2.2.1	What is Ardupilot?	74
2.2.2	Supported Platforms	74
2.2.3	System Architecture	75
2.3	Preparation: Software Tools	76
2.3.1	Mission Planner	76
2.3.2	QGroundControl	78
2.4	Firmware Flashing	80
2.4.1	Pre-Flash Preparation	80
2.4.2	Flashing with Mission Planner	80
2.4.3	Flashing with QGroundControl	82
2.5	Initial Parameter Configuration	83
2.5.1	Introduction to Parameters	83
2.5.2	Critical Parameters	84
2.5.3	Accessing Parameters	85
2.6	Sensor Calibration	87
2.6.1	Accelerometer Calibration (IMU)	87
2.6.2	Compass Calibration (Magnetometer)	88
2.6.3	ESC Calibration (Motors)	90
2.7	Flight Modes	91
2.7.1	Basic Modes (Beginner)	91
2.7.2	Autonomous Modes (Advanced)	92
2.7.3	Configure Flight Modes	92
2.8	PID Control Tuning	94
2.8.1	Introduction to PID Control	94
2.8.2	Basic Tuning: Empirical Method	95
2.8.3	Tool: Tuning in Mission Planner	96
2.9	Mission Planning and Execution	97
2.9.1	Basic Concepts	97
2.9.2	Creating a Mission in Mission Planner	97

2.9.3	Mission Execution	98
2.10	Failsafes: Critical Safety	99
2.10.1	Types of Failsafes	99
2.10.2	Geofence (Safety Perimeter)	101
2.11	Troubleshooting: Common Problems	103
2.11.1	The Drone Does Not Fly Straight	103
2.11.2	Oscillations (Wobble)	103
2.11.3	Won't Arm	104
2.12	Practical Exercises	105
2.12.1	Exercise 1: Flashing and Verification	105
2.12.2	Exercise 2: Full Calibration	105
2.12.3	Exercise 3: First Stable Flight	106
2.12.4	Exercise 4: Simple Mission	107
2.13	Additional Resources	108
2.13.1	Official Documentation	108
2.13.2	Communities	108
2.13.3	Useful Tools	108
2.14	Assessment	109
2.14.1	Knowledge Quiz	109
2.14.2	Practical Exercise	111
2.14.3	Integrated Project	112
2.14.4	Assessment Solutions	114
2.15	Next Step: Module 3 — MAVLink	116
2.16	Glossary of Terms	117
3	MAVLink and Communication Protocols	119
3.1	Module Summary	121
3.2	MAVLink Fundamentals	122
3.2.1	What is MAVLink?	122
3.2.2	Communication Layers	123
3.2.3	MAVLink Packet Structure	124
3.3	MAVLink Traffic Analysis	126
3.3.1	Analysis Tools	126
3.3.2	Typical Traffic Patterns	129
3.4	Remote Control with Python (MAVLink Libraries)	132
3.4.1	Available Libraries	132
3.4.2	Script 1: Basic Connection and Telemetry Reading	133
3.4.3	Script 2: Automatic Takeoff and Landing	136

3.4.4	Script 3: Waypoint Missions	140
3.5	Advanced Extensions	144
3.5.1	Custom Messages (Custom Payloads)	144
3.5.2	Binary Log Analysis	145
3.6	Diagnostics and Troubleshooting	146
3.6.1	Common Communication Problems	146
3.6.2	Link Verification	147
3.6.3	Tool: Network Testing	148
3.7	Practical Exercises	150
3.7.1	Exercise 3.1: Telemetry Monitor	151
3.7.2	Exercise 3.2: Change Flight Mode Remotely	152
3.7.3	Exercise 3.3: MAVLink Traffic Analysis	153
3.7.4	Exercise 3.4: Custom Mission	154
3.8	Complementary Scripts Available	155
3.9	Installation Requirements	157
3.10	Additional Resources	158
3.11	Assessment	159
3.11.1	Knowledge Quiz	159
3.11.2	Practical Exercise	161
3.11.3	Integration Project	162
3.11.4	Assessment Solutions	164
3.12	Safety Notes	166
3.13	Glossary of Terms	167
A	Git for Drones	169
A.1	Introduction	171
A.2	Git Installation	172
A.2.1	Windows	172
A.2.2	macOS	172
A.2.3	Linux (Ubuntu/Debian)	172
A.3	Initial Configuration	173
A.4	Cloning Your First Repository	174
A.4.1	Step 1: Find the Repository URL	174
A.4.2	Step 2: Open Terminal / Command Prompt	175
A.4.3	Step 3: Create a Folder for the Courses	175
A.4.4	Step 4: Clone the Repository	176
A.5	Structure of the Downloaded Project	177
A.6	Detailed Practical Examples	178

A.6.1	Example 1: Download Volume 1 Code (Hardware, Ardupilot, MAVLink)	178
A.6.2	Example 2: Download Code from Both Volumes	179
A.6.3	Example 3: Update Existing Code	180
A.7	Updating the Code	181
A.8	Essential Commands (Cheat Sheet)	182
A.9	Assessment	183
A.9.1	Knowledge Quiz	183
A.9.2	Practical Exercise	185
A.9.3	Integration Project	186
A.9.4	Assessment Solutions	188
A.10	Glossary	190
A.10.1	Essential Git Terms	190
A.10.2	Platform Terms	191
A.10.3	Quick Git Commands (Summary)	191
A.10.4	Project Educational Terms	192
B	Python for Drones	193
B.1	Introduction	195
B.2	Installation and Environment	196
B.2.1	Installing Python	196
B.2.2	Virtual Environment (Virtualenv)	196
B.3	Essential Libraries for Drones	197
B.4	Basic Python Theory	198
B.4.1	Fundamental Data Types	198
B.4.2	Conditionals: if, elif, else	202
B.4.3	Loops: for	204
B.4.4	Advanced Iterations	208
B.4.5	Functions	210
B.5	Downloading Course Examples	216
B.5.1	Step 1: Open Terminal	216
B.5.2	Step 2: Create Folder and Download Repository	217
B.5.3	Step 3: Create Virtual Environment	217
B.5.4	Step 4: Install Dependencies	217
B.5.5	Step 5: Run Your First Script	218
B.5.6	Repository Structure	218
B.5.7	Update Downloaded Code	218
B.5.8	Solving Common Problems	219

B.6	Example 1: Read Basic Telemetry	220
B.6.1	Complete Code	220
B.6.2	Line-by-Line Explanation	221
B.6.3	What Happens When You Run It?	222
B.6.4	Common Error Cases	222
B.7	Example 2: Color Detection (OpenCV)	223
B.7.1	Complete Code	224
B.7.2	Line-by-Line Explanation	225
B.7.3	What You Will See When You Run It	227
B.7.4	How to Detect Other Colors	227
B.7.5	Common Error Cases	228
B.8	Structure of a Drone Script	229
B.9	Common Errors	230
B.10	Assessment	231
B.10.1	Knowledge Quiz	231
B.10.2	Practical Exercise	233
B.10.3	Integration Project	234
B.10.4	Assessment Solutions	236
B.11	Glossary of Terms	238
B.11.1	Python Terms	238
B.11.2	Environment and Execution Terms	239
B.11.3	Drone Libraries Terms	239
B.11.4	Computer Vision Terms	240
	Glossary	241
	References	243